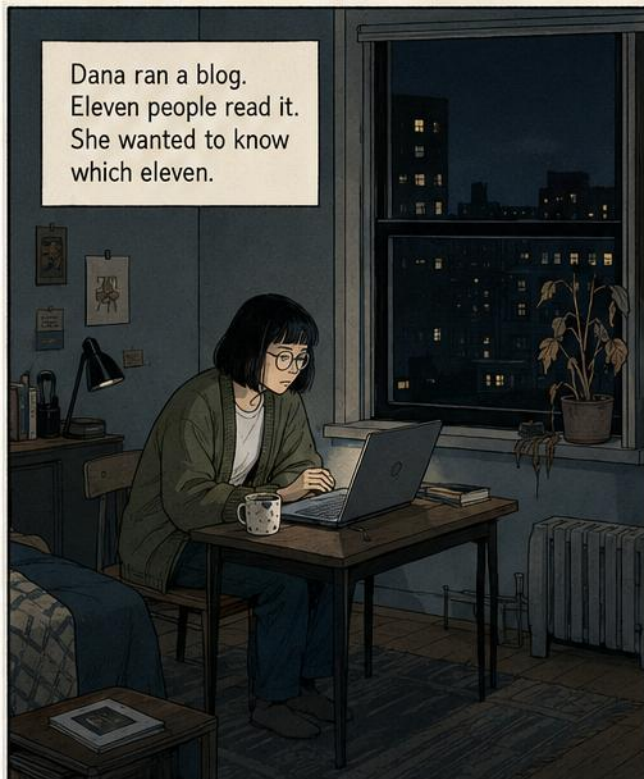


Dana ran a blog.
Eleven people read it.
She wanted to know
which eleven.



EVICITION NOTICE

To: Website Visitor

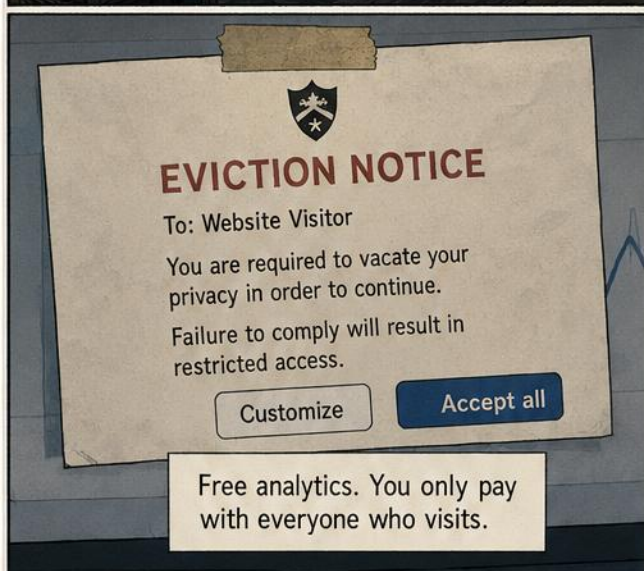
You are required to vacate your
privacy in order to continue.

Failure to comply will result in
restricted access.

Customize

Accept all

Free analytics. You only pay
with everyone who visits.



So Google
watches my
visitors... so
I can watch
my visitors.



There had to be
a version of this
that didn't involve
a stranger in
the room.



1

I want my stats without the surveillance.

Then host it yourself.

2

A VPS is a small computer you rent in a data center. Yours alone, somewhere across town.

3

Two cores. Two gigabytes of memory. The cheapest unit in the building.

\$5 /month

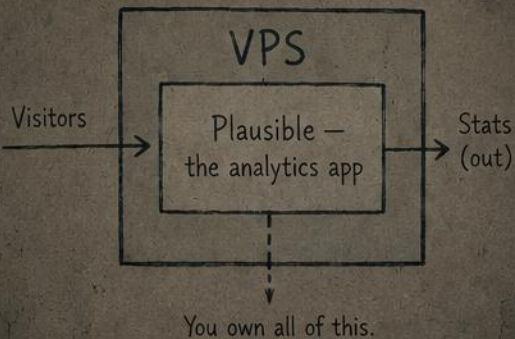
4

It's empty.

That's the point. You move in what you want.

5

Plausible: it counts visits. No cookies, nothing personal, nobody else in the room.



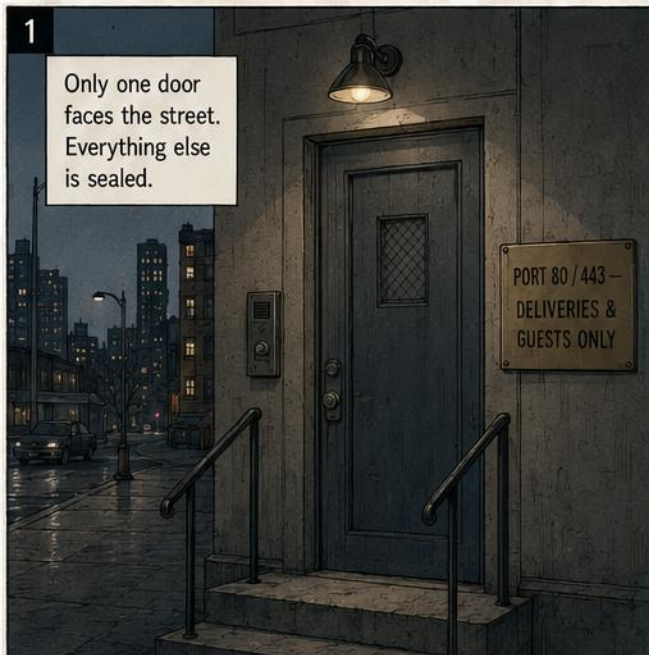
6

She had rented a small dark room across the internet. Now she had to make it secure.

That's the long part.

1

Only one door faces the street. Everything else is sealed.



2

Caddy answers the door. He's the only part of the building the public ever touches.



3

On his own, he requests a certificate from Let's Encrypt and installs the lock — that lock is HTTPS.

Renews itself, too.



4

HTTPS: the message is sealed in transit, and the lock proves the door is really yours.

http



https



5

So the padlock in the browser bar is... him.

It's me.



6

One guarded door. A lock that maintains itself. The hard part wasn't the front.



1

Behind Caddy, two clerks do the actual record-keeping. There is no door from this room to the street.



2

Postgres keeps the boring, important paperwork: your login, your site list.



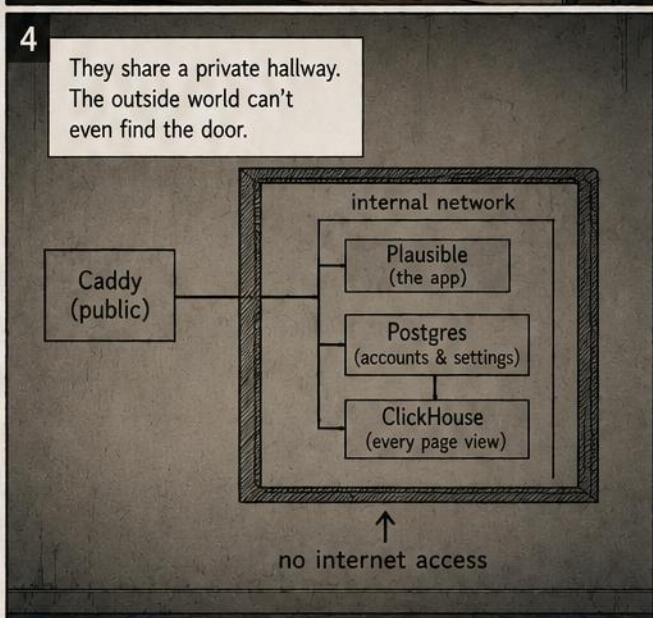
3

ClickHouse only counts. Built to add up millions of visits without breaking a sweat.



4

They share a private hallway. The outside world can't even find the door.



5

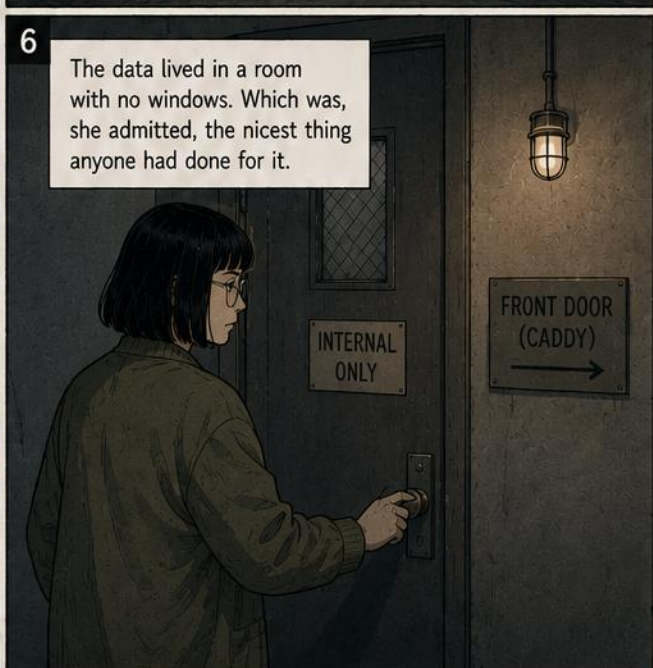
There's no way in here from outside.

Correct.



6

The data lived in a room with no windows. Which was, she admitted, the nicest thing anyone had done for it.



1

The moment a server is online, strangers start trying the door. Constantly. Forever.



2

Fail2Ban watches. Try the wrong key too many times—



3

—and you're locked out. Banned. Next.



4

Unattended upgrades: the building quietly replaces its own locks the night a flaw is found.

You don't even wake up for it.



5

Secrets go in the safe. Never written into the building's blueprints.

1Password

Anyone can read the blueprints. That's the whole idea of sharing them.



6

Keys in the safe. Locks that change themselves. A door that bans the persistent. It was, finally, boring. Boring was the goal.

Hardening
✓ Fail2Ban
✓ Updates
✓ Secrets

```
$ fetch secret db/password
• retrieving from 1Password...
✓ secret provided (used)
✓ secret cleared from memory
```



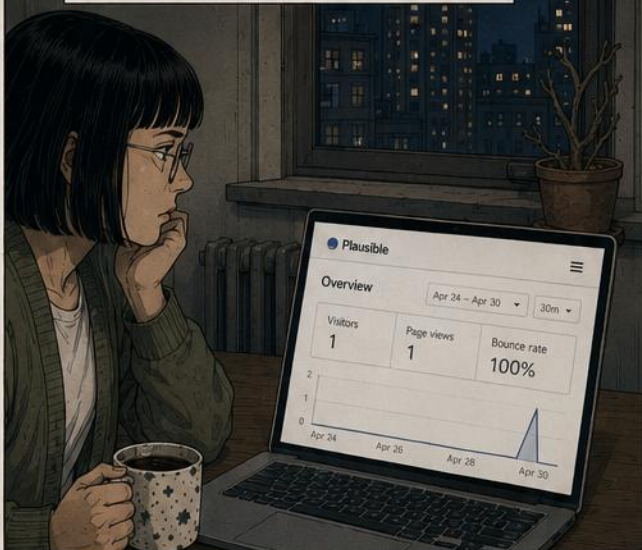
1

Her front door, her back room, her keys.
All hers.



2

No banner. No stranger in the room.
Nothing about anyone, except that they came.



3

Plausible

Overview

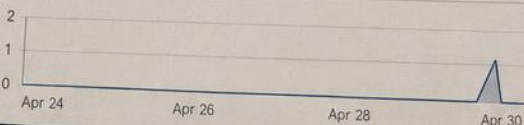
Apr 24 - Apr 30

30m

Visitors today

1

(you)



4

It says one.

Private.
Secure.
Entirely
yours.



5

Nobody can see
your numbers
but you.

There don't
appear to be
any.



6

She had built a perfect, private,
well-defended record of being
almost completely alone online.
It was the most honest thing she owned.

